

M11.5.5 — Strategic Alignment Review

Part 2 — Forecast to Launch

Project: FH6 Farm Tool

Review Type: Founder / Lead Developer Strategic Forecast

Status Date: Post-M11.5 (Operator Runbooks Complete)

Purpose: Define the realistic, soft-locked path from current state to launch.

1. Guiding Principle

The FH6 Farm Tool should not pursue:

maximum capability before launch.

The project should pursue:

maximum trustworthiness within a constrained and valuable MVP.

This distinction matters.

The objective is not:

more features
more automation
more complexity

The objective is:

reliable
predictable
safe
premium-feeling
worth paying for

Launch should represent:

a trustworthy paid product

—not—

“everything we could eventually build.”

The roadmap below intentionally prioritizes:

trust
clarity
reliability
scope discipline
launch readiness

over:

feature accumulation
premature complexity
technical ambition for its own sake

2. Current Position

The project has completed the transition from:

exploratory prototype

to:

structured MVP hardening.

Current maturity:

Controlled MVP Ready — Developer/Manual Use

Meaning:

What exists

- modular architecture
- guarded automation
- validation boundaries
- GitHub repo
- operational runbooks
- reliability documentation
- profile system
- command surface
- controlled scope

What does not yet exist

- launch polish
- external-user readiness

- onboarding
- packaging
- trust-facing presentation
- public support structure
- controlled external testing

Current state is healthy.

The project is sufficiently mature that:

adding major capability now carries greater risk than value unless carefully justified.

3. Soft-Locked Milestone Forecast

This section defines:

the recommended path to launch

The milestones are:

soft-locked

Meaning:

They may adapt when reality changes.

But changes should be:

intentional and justified.

M11.6 — Command Surface Hardening

Purpose

Make the software feel:

professional, predictable, and trustworthy.

Primary goals:

Command consistency

Example:

Standardize confirmation logic.

Avoid:

```
--confirm
--confirm-purchase
--confirm-unlock
--confirm-real-input
```

feeling inconsistent or confusing.

Better refusal messaging

Move from:

```
Refused
```

toward:

```
Refused:
Auto3 multi-car unlock requires:

--confirm-real-input
--confirm-unlock

Reason:
This command may spend skill points.
```

Better operator visibility

Example:

```
Auto3 Multi-Car Unlock
Cars: 4
Traversal: A1 → B1 → C1 → A2
Profile: auto3_default
F8 stop available
```

Goal:

operator confidence.

Pre-flight validation

Refuse invalid operations before execution.

Example:

Requested cars: 7

Refused:

Current validated limit = 4.

Mandatory?

Yes

Launch blocker:

Yes

Reason:

Trust-first software must feel:

intentional and safe.

M11.7 — Reliability & Edge Case Audit

Purpose

Systematically pressure-test assumptions.

Question:

“How does this fail safely?”

Focus areas:

Auto1

- desync
- focus loss
- timing failure

Auto2

- menu drift
- spending risk
- wrong selection

Auto3

- traversal desync
- loading variance
- skill point risk
- reset failures

Global systems

- F8 reliability
- cleanup behavior
- refusal paths
- profile corruption
- weird user inputs

Philosophy:

Safe failure > fragile success

Mandatory?

Yes

Launch blocker:

Yes

M11.8 — Packaging Readiness Planning

Purpose

Prepare future distribution architecture.

Important:

planning

—not—

overbuilding.

Questions answered:

Packaging direction

Basic / Plus.

Profile strategy

What differs?

Licensing assumptions

Minimal or none?

Install flow

How trustworthy should install feel?

Folder structure

Production-ready organization.

Logs

User-facing troubleshooting.

Update philosophy

Manual first?

No complex updater yet?

Mandatory?

Yes

Launch blocker:

Yes

But:

keep complexity intentionally bounded.

M12 — Controlled Internal Beta

Purpose

Use the software like:

an actual paying customer would.

Not:

developer testing.

Meaning:

Intentional real usage.

Examples:

2-hour sessions
repeat usage
misuse attempts
stress testing
breaking assumptions

Question:

“Would I trust this for real?”

This phase exists because:

internal theory eventually stops helping.

Reality matters.

Mandatory?

Yes

Launch blocker:

Yes

M12.5 — Business Foundation Pivot

Purpose

Transition gradually from:

software-only thinking

toward:

launch thinking.

Important:

Software still primary.

Business now becomes:

impossible to ignore.

Tier 1 — Development-Critical Decisions

Must happen.

Basic / Plus packaging

Soft-lock structure.

Recommended:

Basic

Core value proposition:

Auto1
Auto2
Auto3

These are:

non-negotiable foundation.

Plus

Selective premium additions only.

Candidate features:

Auto4
faster Auto2 method
advanced timing control
expanded profile flexibility

Rule:

fair additional value

—not—

artificial feature gatekeeping.

Trust Positioning

Soft-lock positioning:

Recommended:

Safe, Premium, Trustworthy Automation

Not:

aggressive exploit software.

This affects:

- language
- onboarding
- Discord
- branding
- UX tone

Distribution Assumption

Soft-lock:

Discord-first controlled launch

Reason:

Trust advantage.

Benefits:

- direct support
- feedback loops
- real developer presence
- visible updates
- stronger legitimacy

Website:

later

if validated demand emerges.

Mandatory?

Yes

Launch blocker:

Yes

M13 — Final Polish & Launch Readiness

Purpose:

intentional finishing.

This phase must exist.

Launch should not be:

```
code finished  
→ ship
```

Instead:

```
code stable  
→ polish  
→ trust pass  
→ launch
```

Product Polish

- wording consistency
- command clarity
- UX consistency
- operator confidence

Trust Polish

- documentation cleanup
- professionalism
- onboarding clarity
- warnings

Repo Polish

- stale docs
- naming consistency
- cleanup

Launch Polish

- Discord structure
- support channels
- install instructions
- FAQ
- trust messaging

Mandatory?

Yes

Launch blocker:

Yes

M14 — Controlled Public Launch

Recommended launch model:

Controlled Premium MVP

Meaning:

small
intentional
paid
supervised
trust-first
feedback-driven

Not:

mass market
viral
scale-first

Recommended:

Phase 1

Discord-first launch.

Small community.

Feedback-heavy.

Phase 2

Demand validation.

Support learning.

Bug fixing.

Phase 3

Website formalization (optional).

Only if:

demand validated
support burden grows
trust requirements increase

4. Auto4 Positioning

Current recommendation:

Conditional Pre-Launch Candidate

Meaning:

Not mandatory.

Not rejected.

Conditions:

safely bounded
heavy confirmations
explicit warnings
strong validation
clear Plus positioning

Reasoning:

Risk

High.

Core necessity

Low.

User value

Real.

Premium differentiation

Strong.

Conclusion:

build only if safely justified.

Not because:

"might as well."

5. Complexity Budgeting Philosophy

The project should not ask:

"Is this too complex?"

Instead ask:

Can complexity be bounded?
Can we fail safely?
Can we learn through it?
Is value worth complexity?
Will this create momentum or overload?

Reject unmanaged complexity

Bad:

payments
licensing
website
installer
cloud backend
advanced updater

all at once.

Accept bounded complexity

Good:

Discord-first launch
Basic/Plus
Auto4
faster Plus Auto2
trust systems

when:

safely testable.

Complexity is:

allowed when intentionally managed.

6. Deferred Scope Register

Deferred $\neq$ forgotten.

Deferred

Website

Reason:

Not development-critical yet.

Trigger:

Validated demand.

Deferred

Pricing optimization

Reason:

Too early.

Trigger:

Launch preparation.

Deferred

Advanced licensing

Reason:

Complexity too high.

Trigger:

Demand validation.

Deferred

Advanced updater

Reason:

Premature.

Trigger:

Support burden.

Deferred

Broad UI/Desktop expansion

Reason:

CLI currently sufficient.

Trigger:

Post-launch maturity.

Deferred

Advanced Auto3 scaling

Reason:

4-car validation sufficient.

Trigger:

Future milestone.

7. Launch Threshold Criteria

Launch should happen when:

Software

- ✓ stable
- ✓ predictable
- ✓ documented
- ✓ failure-safe
- ✓ trustable

Product

- ✓ understandable
- ✓ installable
- ✓ premium-feeling
- ✓ expectation-meeting

Support

- ✓ Discord structure exists
- ✓ onboarding exists
- ✓ troubleshooting path exists

Founder Confidence

- ✓ respectful of complexity
- ✓ realistic expectations
- ✓ willingness to iterate

Important:

Launch threshold is:

good enough to deserve payment

—not—

perfection.

8. Failure Modes To Avoid

Failure Mode 1

Scope creep.

Biggest danger.

Failure Mode 2

Perfectionism delay.

"Just one more thing."

Failure Mode 3

Premature business complexity.

Website, payments, licensing too early.

Failure Mode 4

Overbuilding Plus.

Keep Plus selective.

Failure Mode 5

Trust failure.

Biggest commercial risk.

Trust matters more than capability.

9. Realistic Launch Window

Current assessment:

Strong possibility of launch readiness if milestone discipline remains high.

Risk:

Not technical inability.

Risk is:

drift.

Meaning:

too many features
too much complexity
too much delay

Momentum matters.

10. Final Recommendation

Recommended path:

M11.6
↓
M11.7
↓
M11.8
↓
M12
↓
M12.5
↓
M13
↓
M14

Current recommendation:

Stay disciplined. Finish intentionally. Launch conservatively. Learn from reality.